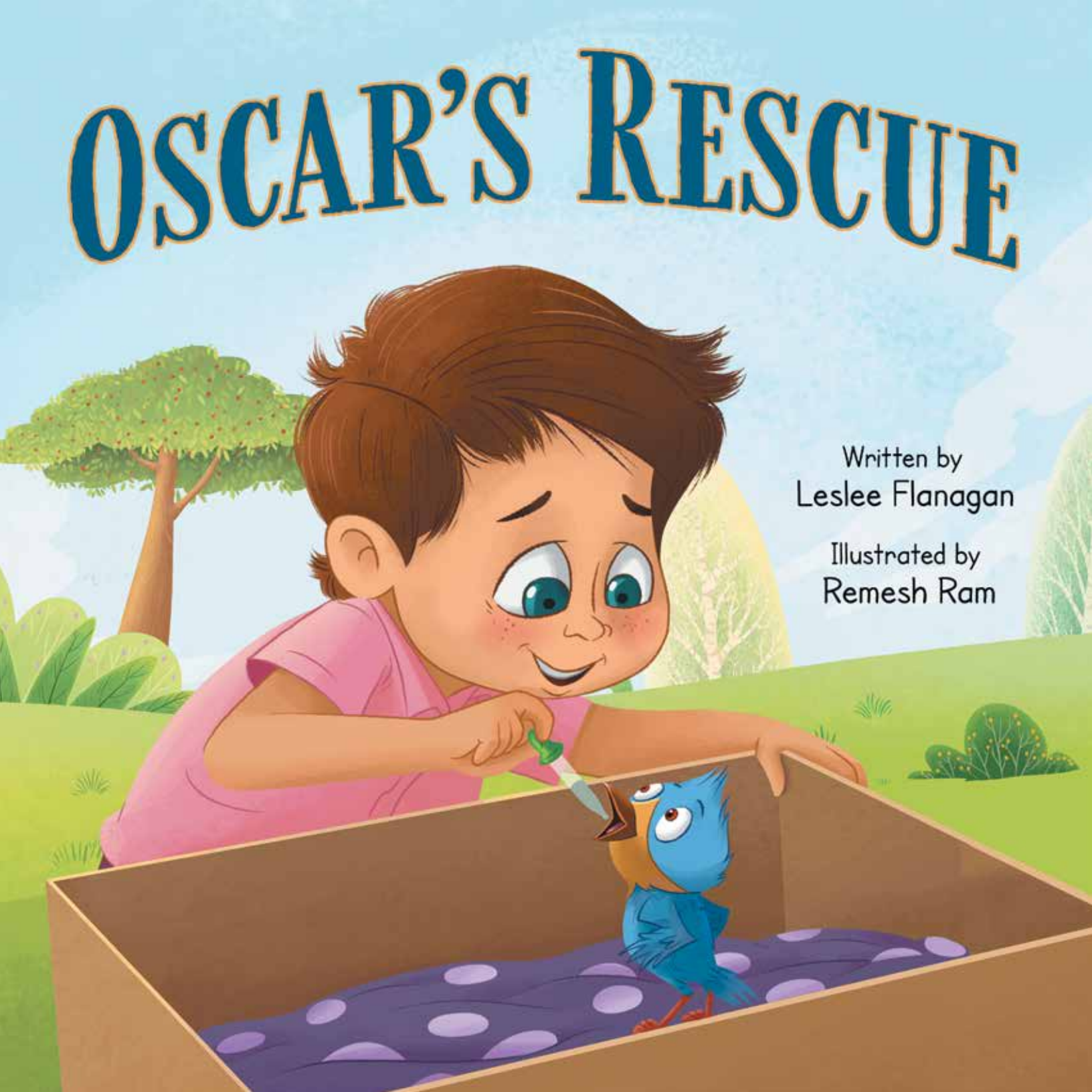
Oscar's Rescue



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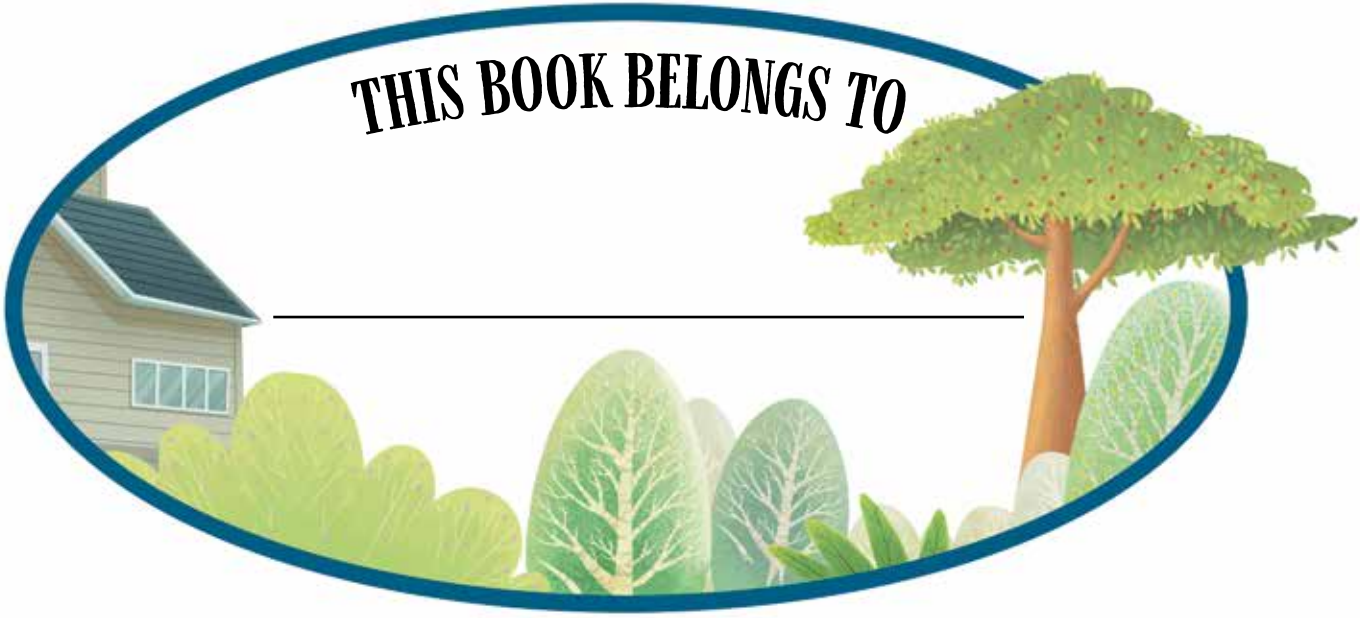
THIS BOOK BELONGS TO

This book is dedicated with love to all my grandchildren
as they continue to inspire me to write stories.

Thank you, Emily and Kelsey, for your insight and suggestions.

Thank you, Gram, for encouraging me to write all those years ago.

A special thank you to my husband Chip for his encouragement as I pursue my dream.

LESLEE M. FLANAGAN

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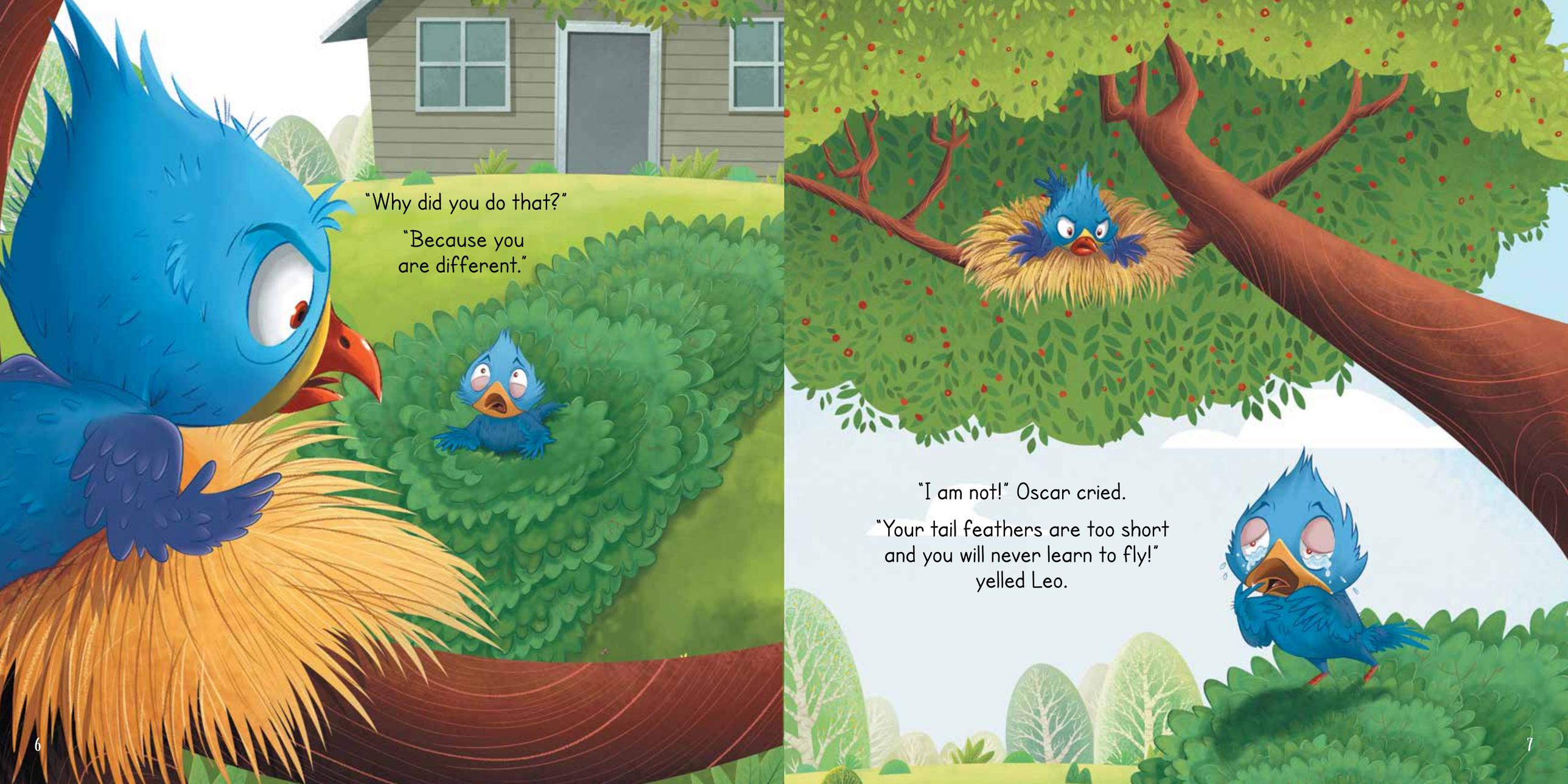
OSCAR'S RESCUE

WRITTEN BY LESLEE FLANAGAN
ILLUSTRATED BY REMESH RAM

THUD!

Oscar's eyes flew open.
He was on the ground!

"What happened?" he asked.
"I pushed you out of the nest," his brother
Leo said, looking down from the tree.



"Why did you do that?"

"Because you are different."

"I am not!" Oscar cried.

"Your tail feathers are too short and you will never learn to fly!" yelled Leo.

"Dad, look! I found a baby bird in the grass!" Jaylen shouted. "Isn't he cute?"

"He must have fallen out of his nest," said Dad. "I'll get the ladder and we can carefully return him to his home."

Oscar felt Jaylen's warm fingers gently closing around him. Up he went. He was back in his nest.

"Dad, he fell out again!" cried Jaylen.
"Oh dear, that's not normal," said Dad. "Maybe there's something wrong with him."

"Why do you say that?" Jaylen demanded.
"Well, his tail feathers are too short," Dad answered. "He may never fly. He won't be safe up there."

"Then I will take care of him!" Jaylen scooped Oscar up and cradled the tiny bird close to his heart. He limped to the shed.

Jaylen found a box and put a clean towel in the bottom.

Oscar fell sound asleep in his new nest.

He woke up hungry. He poked his little head up and chirped.

Dad mixed soft food that baby birds like. Jaylen squirted a tiny bit of it into Oscar's mouth. Oscar swallowed it.

Jaylen fed him several times each day.

One week later, Jaylen gently carried Oscar outside.
He lifted him onto a swaying branch.

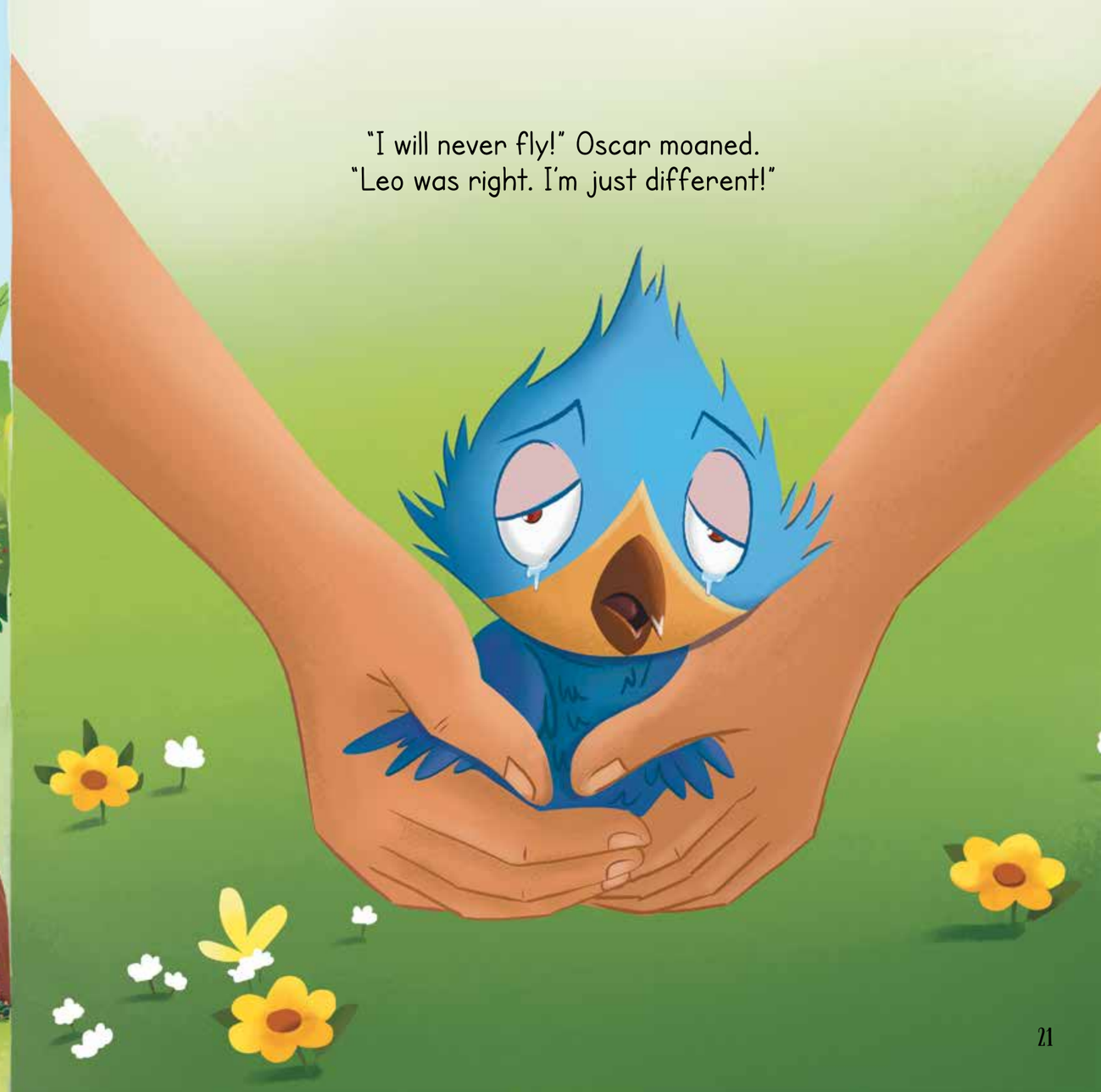
"It is time for you to learn
to fly," said Jaylen,
taking a step back.

"Fly to me, little bird."
Oscar trembled. His feet clutched the branch.

"You can do this!"
Jaylen said.

Oscar flapped his wings...
and jumped.
For a moment
he was in the air!

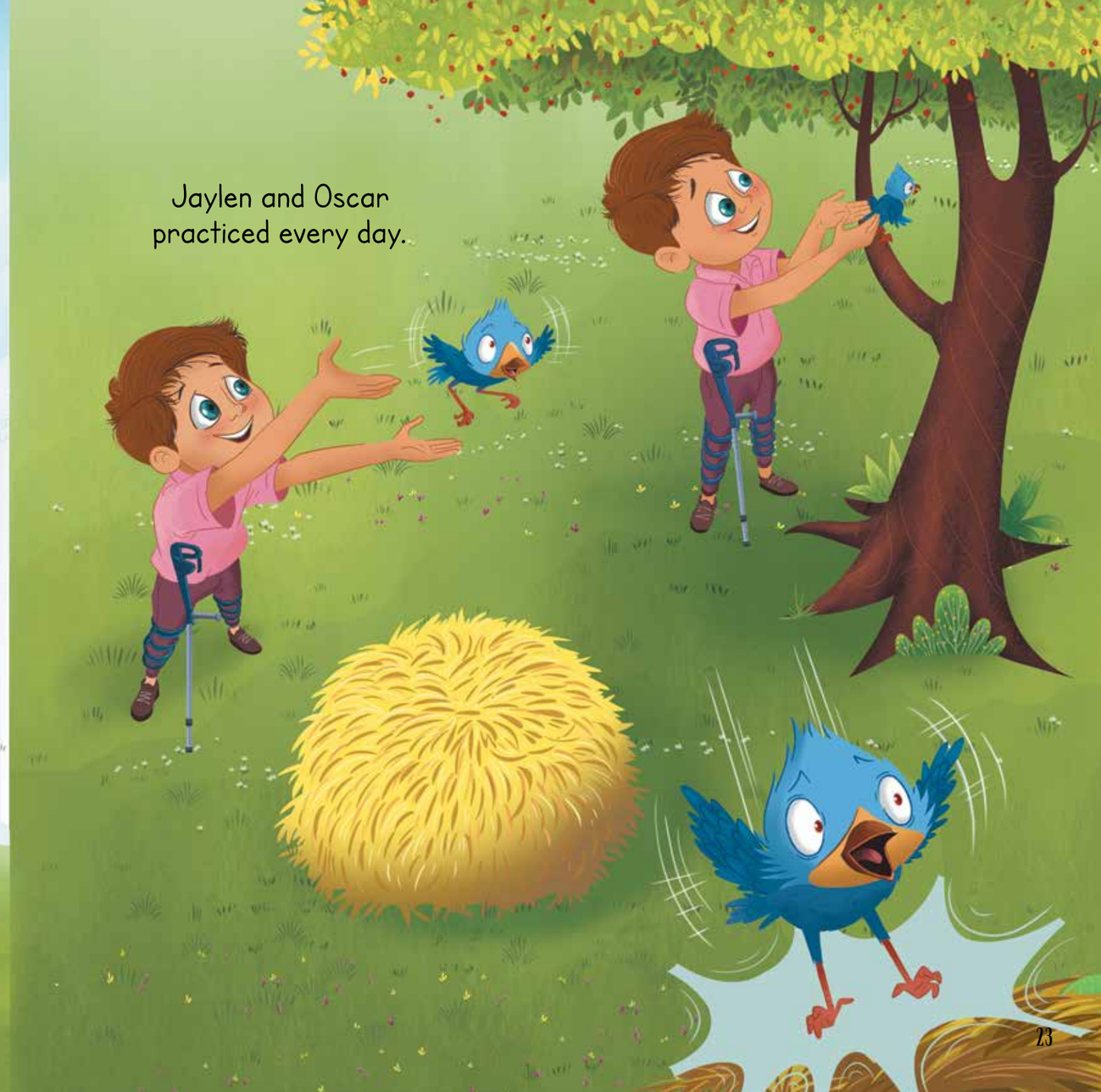
Jaylen scooped Oscar up.



"I will never fly!" Oscar moaned.
"Leo was right. I'm just different!"

"I sometimes have trouble walking," Jaylen said, pointing to his own legs.

"You just need more practice."



Jaylen and Oscar practiced every day.

One afternoon Oscar heard his brother
Leo shouting, "Help! I'm stuck!"
Leo was tangled in a net!
Stalking toward him was a cat!
Oscar chirped and squawked.

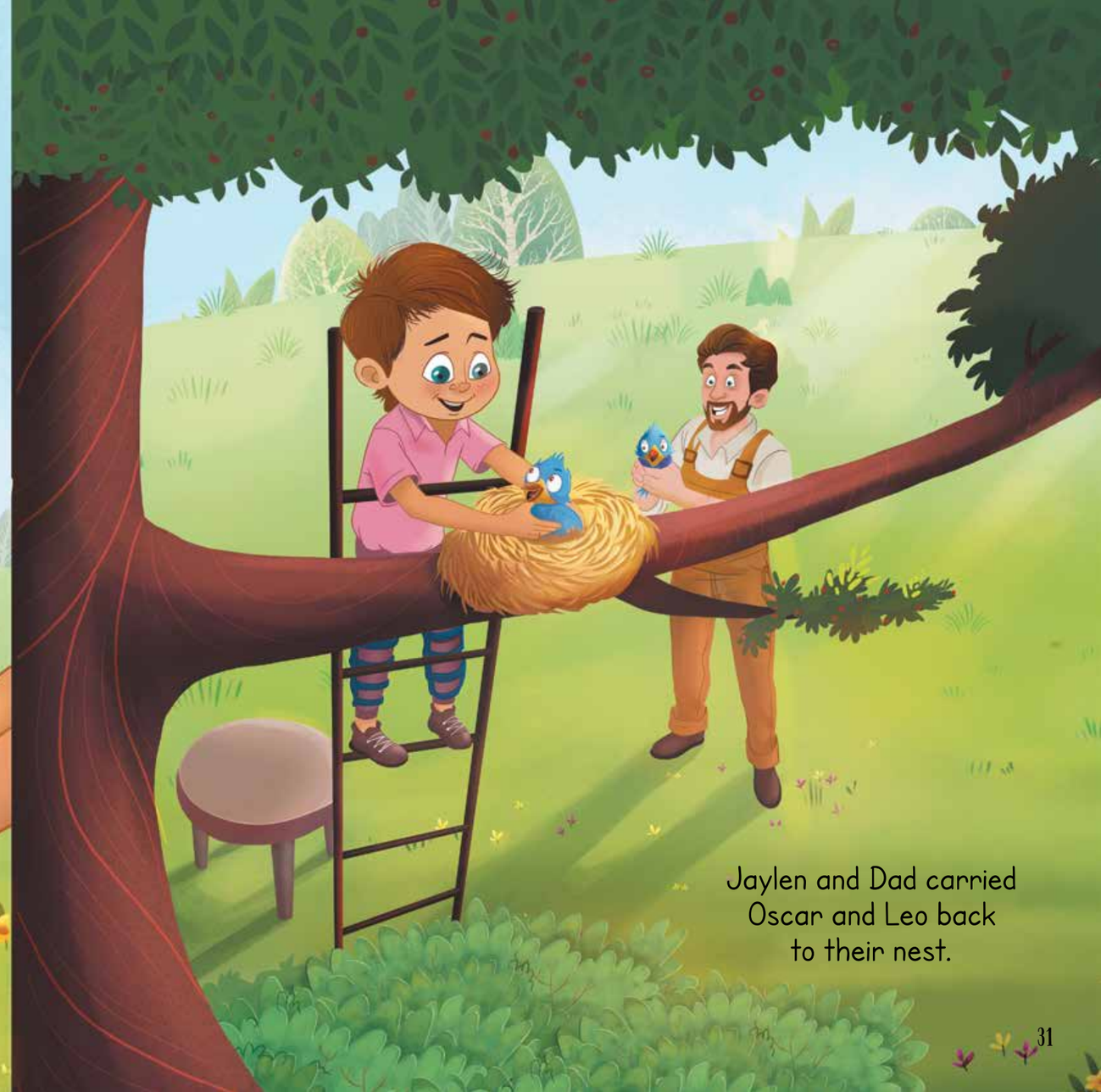
Then Oscar flapped his wings and... he flew!
Wings beating, he flew toward the bush.
SWOOSH! He landed next to Leo.
He squawked as loud as he could.
The cat ran away.

Jaylen scooped Oscar up.
"I knew you could do it!" he said with a smile.
Leo stared at Oscar. "Why did you save
my life when I was so mean to you?"

"You're my brother,"
was Oscar's answer.

"I am sorry for saying you were different. You are a superhero," said Leo.

"But I am different," Oscar answered. "And I am not a superhero. You needed help, and I helped you."



Jaylen and Dad carried Oscar and Leo back to their nest.

Oscar smiled. Maybe—just maybe—it was okay to be different.

About the Author

Leslee Flanagan loves to write. Her experiences as a teacher, mom, and grandmother provide numerous ideas for writing her stories. Over the years she has nurtured and cared for a wide variety of animals both domesticated and wild. In recent years she can be found volunteering at the Beluga habitat at the Aquarium near her home. Leslee loves the challenge of learning new things. With her books she hopes you will be inspired to keep learning and have fun along the way.

About the Illustrator

He is co-founder of Prayan Animation Studio with over 15 years of experience in animation & illustration industry. He led Prayan Animation Studio for a glorious 10 years. He along with his team of illustrators work together in bringing out the stories into life with their beautiful and eye-catching illustrations

Thank You

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https://bit.ly/oscarsrescue

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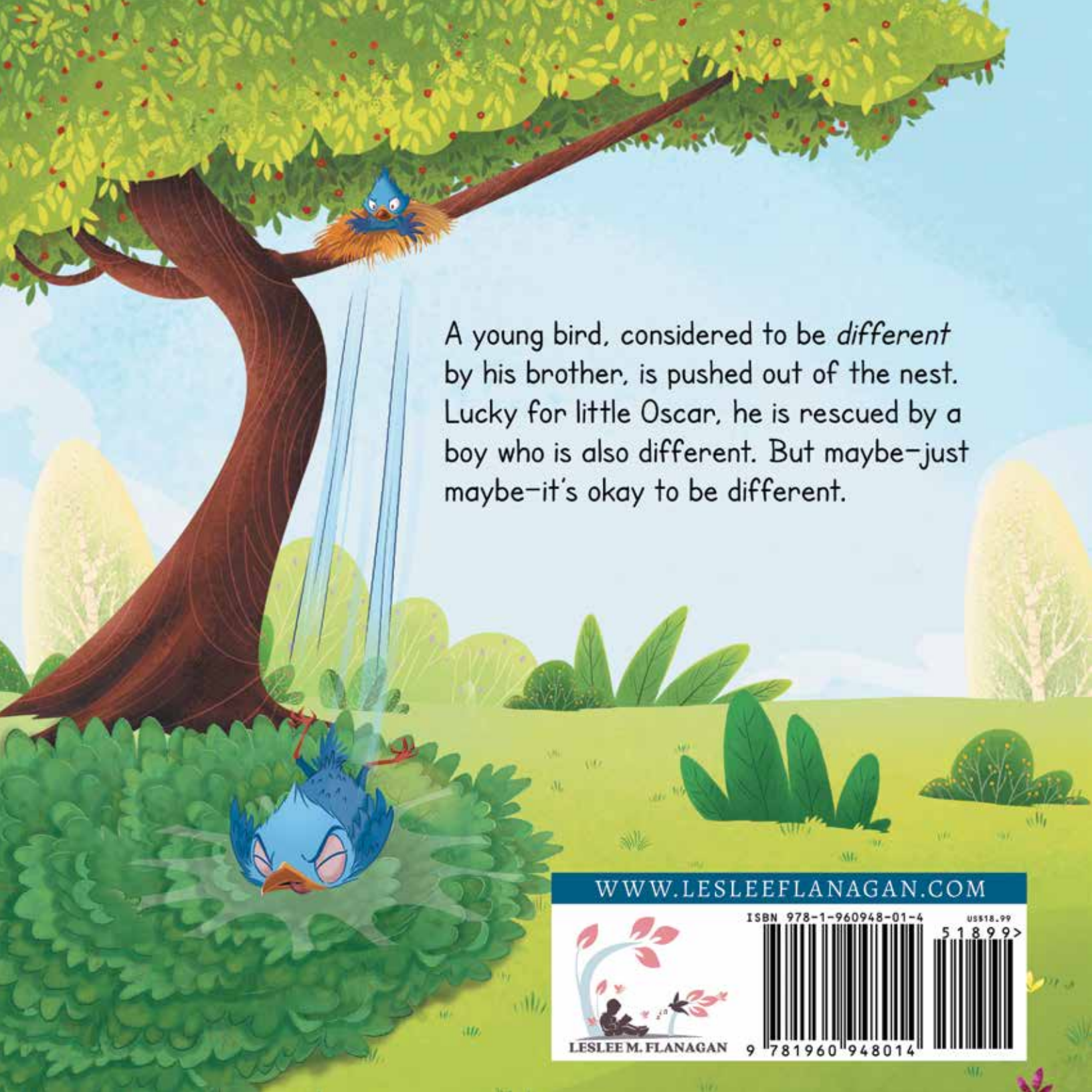

A young bird, considered to be *different* by his brother, is pushed out of the nest. Lucky for little Oscar, he is rescued by a boy who is also different. But maybe—just maybe—it's okay to be different.

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